

# Supported vs. Unsupported Claims

Workbook 2 - Apply - Focused practice

## Directions

Treat each item as close-choice practice. Preserve scope, certainty, and the exact job of each piece of evidence.

### Exercise 1

A factory pilot reduced machine idle time by 9 percent for one production line while output stayed similar. The pilot lasted four weeks.

Task: Which claim is best supported?

- A. The new process may reduce idle time on that line without reducing output during a short pilot.
- B. The process will permanently raise profits across every factory.
- C. The process caused workers to become more skilled.
- D. The pilot proves all machines should use the process immediately.

### Exercise 2

A town planted trees along one block. Summer surface temperatures on that block averaged 2°C lower than on a nearby unshaded block, but building materials also differed.

Task: Which statement is too strong?

- A. The shaded block was cooler during the measurements.
- B. Tree shade may have contributed to lower temperatures.
- C. The data prove trees caused the entire temperature difference.
- D. Building differences complicate the comparison.

### Exercise 3

A company survey found that 72 percent of respondents preferred flexible start times. Only 35 percent of employees completed the survey.

Task: Which conclusion is most defensible?

- A. Most survey respondents preferred flexible starts, but the response rate limits claims about all employees.
- B. Most employees definitely prefer flexible starts.
- C. Flexible starts improve productivity.
- D. The survey is useless because not everyone answered.

### Exercise 4

After a school added quiet-study rooms, library visits increased 14 percent. No data were collected on why students visited.

Task: Which claim needs additional evidence?

- A. Library visits increased after the rooms were added.
- B. The quiet rooms caused the entire increase in visits.
- C. The school did not collect reasons for visits.
- D. The increase was 14 percent.

# Answer reasoning

Check your reasoning, not only your answer.

For every question, compare your reasoning with the explanation. If you missed the item, identify the exact step where your reasoning changed the source or used evidence for the wrong job.

## Exercise 1

**Best answer:** A. The new process may reduce idle time on that line without reducing output during a short pilot.

**Why:** It preserves the measured outcome, group, duration, and uncertainty.

## Exercise 2

**Best answer:** C. The data prove trees caused the entire temperature difference.

**Why:** The comparison contains another meaningful difference, so the cause is not isolated.

## Exercise 3

**Best answer:** A. Most survey respondents preferred flexible starts, but the response rate limits claims about all employees.

**Why:** It reports the result while respecting the incomplete participation.

## Exercise 4

**Best answer:** B. The quiet rooms caused the entire increase in visits.

**Why:** Timing alone does not establish the reason for the increase.

## Mistake check

For every miss, label the reason: wrong claim, evidence mismatch, too broad or too certain, reasoning gap, source or format confusion, or rushed reading. Then write one sentence explaining what you will check next time.